

DESIGNING HEX TOWNS



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Designed by Loki's Lair

INTRODUCTION

THE PURPOSE

Creating towns for your campaigns can sometimes be a bit exhaustive. Sure there are many ways to create settlements but I find that most Dungeon Masters want to use a system that allows them to spend less time prepping and more time playing. This system encourages that but gives your settlements the depth they need in order to be interesting to your players.

This system allows you to gamify the experience of creating settlements and the process from start to finish is a quick and efficient one. I have included optional charts and other content in this book which will allow you to go deeper into meaningful worldbuilding if you wish, but that's up to you. Having your settlements split into hexes also allows for your players to explore the towns they visit. They can discover the makeup of your towns and what opportunities they await.

WHATS MY SETTLEMENT?

Settlements in the Medieval World were not commonly self-sustainable. Each location provided specific value through resources, trade, and military presence. These settlements were linked up into a local and global trade network which would take resources like spices, wines, silks and other luxury textiles from Italy all the way to London. What we want to do first is focus on creating the foundation where we understand the type of settlement that we have. We can eventually develop this and other settlements into a network to understand the movement of trade and people.

Roll a d8 or a d10 depending on your preferences. For larger settlements, you can roll twice to have two different settlement types which you can represent as different districts in your town (trade district, crafting district, noble district).



Roll d8/d10	TYPE	DESCRIPTION
1-2	Farming	Settlements with a strong agricultural presence. They are the lifeblood of every nation state and many of these settlements are required for trade, war and growth.
3-4	Resource	Settlements that provide a specific resource of various value. This is primarily a Raw Resource which can be gathered.
5-6	Military	Settlements which serves as a military installation, allowing the local rulers to exert power and influence across the land. Many trained soldiers reside here.
7-8	Market	Settlements which create and trade commodities from Farming and Resource settlements. They are usually located on major roadways or between two larger settlements.
9-10	Industry	Settlements which use raw resources to create valuable commodities.

The industry option is based heavily on the types of settlements that are nearby which is why there is not a column in the table with options. Consider what resources are locally available and pick one. You can alternatively roll on the Resource chart.

Use this optional table below to define the use of your settlement. What does it provide?

d10	Farming	Resource	Military
1	Cereals (Wheat, Oats, Barley)	Lumber	Camp
2	Root Vegetables (Potatoes, Beets)	Leather	Outpost
3	Pulse Crops (Beans, Peas)	Flax/Wool	Tower
4	Forage Crops (Cabbage, Kale)	Stone	Blockhouse
5	Fibre Crops (Flax, Bamboo, Hemp)	Coal/Peat	Keep
6	Fruit (Apples, Pears)	Copper	Castle
7	Pastoral (Livestock)	Iron	
8	Hunting (Deer, Boar)	Silver	
9		Gold	
10		Luxury Resource	

Farmers typically don't grow the same specific crop every year, at least in regards to Crop Rotation. Crop rotation is the agricultural practice where different crops are planted in a specific sequence on the same land over several seasons. This method helps maintain soil fertility, reduce soil erosion, and prevent the buildup of pests and diseases by alternating the types of plants grown. Cereals, Root Vegetables, Pulse Crops and Forage Crops are the ones commonly used for Crop Rotation.

Military settlements can be solely based on the settlement (ie. a Keptown), but there is nothing wrong with just having a generic town with a tower or castle nearby. It may be worth considering what else the town does though unless you want it to be a low interest location.

CREATING A TOWN

WHO RUNS THE SETTLEMENT?

Every settlement has a ruler. These can be elected figures, freeholders, servants of god, or nobility. You may roll or choose which of these factions has control over the settlement and you can use this to give the settlement more flavour and depth.

1. Elective
2. Freeholder
3. Military
4. Clergy
5. Nobility
6. Roll twice, joint-rulership (either power sharing or one serves the other like a vassal)

What is a freeholder?

A freeholder was an individual who owned land outright, free from the obligation of feudal service to a lord. Freeholders had the legal right to sell, bequeath, or otherwise dispose of their land as they saw fit. Yeomen and minor gentry could be amongst those considered to be freeholders.

Clergy running a military settlement?

A bishop ruling a keep could make it a centre of spirituality, perhaps built to protect a holy site or valuable artefacts. It might even be a fortified monastery with battlements. If your choice doesn't fit your settlement, consider a secret ruler who is actually in control.

CREATE A HEX SETTLEMENT

With the other details defined. We can now begin mapping and designing the settlement. Each hex is considered a zone or district which defines a key area. We define this zone with a colour, ranging from Yellow to Purple and this colour represents the typical class of workers located here. Unlike Hex Maps used for long-distance travel, hexes in this system are abstract and are used more for understanding the layout of a settlement as opposed to counting miles or hours. Settlements don't normally take long to travel across so having a distance like 100 sq ft per hex could work but it would require a lot of maths and consideration. What I would do instead is designate the population size on average for each hex. This is a much better measurement tool to use to determine scale, which is the important measurement for your settlements.

My recommendation is to use strong, round numbers like 50, 100, 250, 500 and have as many hexes as you have population. If you have a town with one thousand people, you could have 10 hexes, each with a population of 100 on average.

EXAMPLE NAMES	TOWN SIZE	OPTION A	OPTION B	OPTION C
Town of Spratton	Large Town, 4800 POP	12 Hexes x 400 Pop	6 Hexes x 800 Pop	8 Hexes x 600 Pop
Town of Dodford	Small Town, 800 POP	16 Hexes x 50 Pop	8 Hexes x 100 Pop	4 Hexes x 200 Pop

Now, using an empty hex grid, designate each hex with a number. From there, roll a 20-sided dice to determine what each hex is. Colour each hex in based on the results and create a simple list noting the Hex Number, District, Type, and Landmark. The Landmarks included in the list below are examples; and you can use them or come up with your own. Also consider your Town's type when using this system. Military settlements will have at least one military hex and Market towns will have at least one Hex which is a Market or Mercantile Type.

HEX ZONE TABLE:

d20	Zone	Type	Landmark	Notes
1	Residential	Poor and Deprived	Slum, Tenement, Workhouse	
2	Commercial	Secret Society	Black Market, Thieves' Guild, Pitfighting	
3	Residential	Working Class	Tavern, Inn	
4	Commercial	Mercantile	Market, Grand Forge	
5	Commercial	Infrastructure	Gate, Granary, Warehouse	
6	Military	Defense	Guardpost, Tower	
7	Military	Infrastructure	Barrack, Jail	
8	Military	Mercantile	Armoury, Weaponsmith	
9	Residential	Middle Class	Paved Roads, Statues,	
10	Commercial	Infrastructure	Merchant's Guild, City Hall	
11	Commercial	Mercantile	Clothier, Fletcher, Alchemy, Scribes	
12	Recreational	Entertainment	Arena, Theatre	
13	Commercial	Education	Academy/University	
14	Residential	Upper Class	Fountain, Country Club, Private Garden	
15	Religious	Worship	Church, Temple, Cathedral	
16	Religious	Infrastructure	Shrine, Soup Kitchen, Hospital	
17	Religious	Secret Society	Cult Lair, Catacombs, Barrows	
18	Nobility	Mercantile	Jeweller, Bank	
19	Nobility	Seat of Power	Villa, Estate, Palace, Citadel	
20	Arcane Arts	Infrastructure	Wizard's Tower, Magic Guild, Magical Fountain	

WHAT'S NEXT?

The basic outline of your settlement is completed. Feel free to use any of these optional tables below to add more details where you think it's important. You can choose or roll on these charts to add more depth to your settlements and figure out which key buildings you want to design information and lore about. There isn't a right or wrong way of doing this and these rolls do not dictate that there is or is not such a building in the town but that the building rolled is important to the town.

All towns have a blacksmith, but rolling blacksmith on the table means the blacksmith in town is well known or good at a specific type of smithing.

WRITING LORE & DESCRIPTIONS

Keep it clear and simple. Each building should have a paragraph or two at most explaining the location, the NPCs, and what is for sale if relevant. An example of a write-up will be included at the end of the PDF for you to check out.

The long-term plan for a settlement is one of change, where you'll be adding to your town over the course of a campaign.

COMMON BUILDINGS TABLE

All settlements typically have a blacksmith and a church. These charts are particularly useful for smaller settlements, helping you identify key buildings for player interaction. Roll 1d4 for a smaller settlement or 2d4 for a larger one. Keep and encourage duplications to create local competition.

List the buildings and guilds you rolled, and apply them to your hex map. Each location should be assigned to a specific hex. Alternatively, you can roll to determine which hex each building occupies based on the number of hexes you have. It's absolutely fine to have multiple locations in a hex, actually I think that should be the goal.

GUILDS TABLE

Guilds can be classified into two types: Craft and Merchant. Craft guilds consisted of craftsmen and artisans in the same trade, emerging due to growing city populations and increasing labour specialisation. Merchant guilds included most or all merchants in a town or city, engaging in regional and long-distance trade. These guilds were influential in local governments, often led by wealthy and powerful citizens.

Guilds also existed in rural areas, mainly for social and religious purposes. Important village members might belong to these "city guilds." For large towns, roll 1d4+2 times on this chart; for small cities, roll 2d4+2 times.

d12	COMMON BUILDINGS	d20	UNCOMMON BUILDINGS	d20	GUILDS
1	Barracks	1	Academy	1	Architects
2	Blacksmith	2	Arena	2	Armors
3	Carpenter	3	Armoury	3	Bakers
4	Church	4	Bathhouse	4	Beggars
5	General Store	5	Bank	5	Blacksmiths
6	Inn	6	Brewery	6	Brewers
7	Leatherworker	7	Brothel	7	Carpenters
8	Marketplace	8	Clothier	8	Cartographers
9	Mill	9	Gambling Den	9	Dyers & Tanners
10	Tannery	10	Glazery	10	Gemcutters
11	Tavern	11	Jail	11	Goldsmiths
12	Warehouse	12	Jewellery Shop	12	Herbalists
		13	Library	13	Masons
		14	Pawn Shop	14	Mercenaries
		15	Quarry	15	Miners
		16	Tannery	16	Scribes
		17	Theatre	17	Tailors
		18	Stonemasonry	18	Tavernkeepers
		19	Wizard's Tower	19	Thieves
		20	Workhouse	20	Wizards

DYNAMIC EVENTS

To create a truly engaging and dynamic game, it's essential to have a structured system for creating and running events. These events are specifically tied to each town and can impact a single zone, multiple zones, or the entire town. The tables below are designed to help you generate organic stories that drive emergent gameplay.

The inclusion of these events is to create narrative choice for your players. Some of the events may have already occurred or will happen in another location if you are using this system for multiple settlements. But if

the players are nearby, you should have the event take place in real-time, like a festival, tournament or the arrival of a caravan. Events like “Crime Rises” should be more passive, where you can drip-feed your players what’s going on over time.

d20	DYNAMIC EVENTS TABLE		
1	New Threat - A new danger presents itself to the settlement. Use the supplemental charts to determine the threat and cause of it.	11	New Leader - The settlement declares a new leader. Refer to “Who Runs My Settlement?” and roll on the appropriate chart. Consider whether this is a temporary arrangement or a permanent change of power.
2	Crime Rises - A series of crimes cause disruption. Designate a hex where these crimes are located. Roll a d6. On a 1,2, or 3, a new thieves' guild is created for the criminals involved.	12	Cult Established - A secretive group establishes a presence within the settlement, spreading its influence through clandestine rituals, indoctrination, and recruitment. Roll or designate a hex as the Cult's main location.
3	Festival - The settlement holds a festival in celebration of a key part of their culture or religion. Roll a d6 for Festival Size. • 1-2) Small - 1 Hex • 3-4) Medium - 1d4 Hexes • 5-6) Large - Full Settlement Consider using the supplemental table “Festivals & Tournaments” below.	13	Tournament - A tournament is held, attracting combatants and spectators. Players can participate as fighters, bet on matches, or ensure the event runs smoothly. Roll a d6 for Tournament Size. • 1-2) Small - 1 Hex • 3-4) Medium - 1d4 Hexes • 5-6) Large - Full Settlement Consider using the supplemental table “Festivals & Tournaments” below.
4	Merchant Caravan Arrives - A unique caravan has arrived to town from further afield. Determine the origin of the caravan and roll on the Caravan charts provided below.	14	Trade Network - The town secures a trade agreement with a neighbouring region and begins to acquire new commodities, not typically found here. 1d4 Hexes of your choice are improved from Dark Yellow to Yellow, Yellow to Green, Green to Dark Green, or Dark Green to Purple.
5	Construction Project - A new construction project begins, leading to an influx of workers and increased demand for materials. Designate a random hex and roll on the Common or Uncommon Buildings chart for the building result.	15	Settlement Expansion - Construction projects have led to an expansion of the town. Add an additional 1d4 hexes to this map and roll a d20 for each hex to determine what the purpose of each is.
6	Building on Fire - A building ignites in a randomly determined hex. Roll a d6 to determine the tier of this fire. • 1-2) Minor - Affects 1 Hex • 3-4) Major - Affects 1d4+1 Hexes • 5-6) Great - Affects all Hexes If player characters are present, they may take part in trying to put out the fires. If they succeed, they can diminish the damage by 1 tier.	16	Plague Outbreak - A sudden outbreak approaches the settlement, beginning to spread fear and panic. Roll a d6 for the level of danger: • 1-2) Minor - Affects 1 Hex • 3-4) Major - Affects 1d4+1 Hexes • 5-6) Great - Affects all Hexes. Will spread to nearby settlements. If player characters are present, they may take part in trying to diminish the plague. If they succeed, they can diminish the damage by 1 tier.
7	Guild Leaves - An existing organisation closes its doors and leaves the settlement. Roll or choose to determine which guild is leaving.	17	New Guild Arrives - A new organisation opens its doors to the general public in the local settlement. Roll on the Guilds table above to determine the specialisation.
8	Royal Visit - Member/s of the ruling class visit, prompting celebrations and heightened security. Consider who is coming and why they are coming. Is it politically motivated? Is it to open up a new industry?	18	Local Revolt - Locals are beginning to turn against those who rule this settlement. This begins as rallies and civil unrest but can grow more dangerous over time. The next time you roll/choose a dynamic event in the future, roll a d4. If you roll even, the unrest ends. If you roll odds, it

			grows into a full revolt with rebels. Players can intervene and end this early through roleplay and action.
9	Resource lost - The current commodity that the settlement uses is lost, whether this is a farm crop, mineral, or the presence of the military. Define the reason why this has happened. Maybe the mine collapsed or the crops had a blight. Without a use for the settlement, people will start to leave. Either allow this migration or come up with a story to seek a new resource (prospecting, farming, etc)	19	New Resource available - A new commodity has been discovered or developed. Roll an additional time on the Town Type table. Adding new hexes or buildings to existing hexes is a good idea. If you end up rolling military, that means a fortification has been built in or near the settlement, which will host soldiers.
10	Nearby Dungeon Discovered - Locals discover an ancient crypt, temple, or Dungeon that is not far from the settlement. This has led to an influx of mercenaries and adventurers, interested in exploring it.	20	The DM chooses or may roll 2d20s, combining the results into one, bigger event.

SUPPLEMENTAL TABLES

FESTIVAL / TOURNAMENTS

Creating engaging festival and tournament scenarios can breathe life into your mediaeval settlement, offering players a vibrant and dynamic backdrop for their adventures. These events provide not only a break from the usual routine but also opportunities for unique interactions, character development, and storytelling. Roll a number of events based on the size of the festival:

- **Small** - 1d4+1
- **Medium** - 1d4+2
- **Large** - 1d6+3

	EVENTS TABLE	DESCRIPTION
1	Archery Contest	Participants compete to hit targets at varying distances with their bows.
2	Arm Wrestling	A test of strength where two participants lock hands and try to force the other's arm down.
3	Ball Games (Football, Handball)	Early forms of football or handball played with a leather ball.
4	Coconut Shy	Participants try to knock down coconuts or similar objects from their stands using wooden balls.
5	Crafting Demonstrations	Participants watch and try their hand at crafts such as blacksmithing, pottery, weaving, and woodworking.
6	Dice Games	Various games of chance played with dice, often involving betting.
7	Drinking Contest or Games	Competitions to see who can drink the most alcohol, or games associated with alcohol like beer pong and flip cup.
8	Fortune Telling	Booths where participants can have their fortunes told through various means, such as tarot, palm or crystal ball.
9	Hammer Striking	Participants use a large hammer to strike a lever, attempting to ring a bell at the

		top of a tall post.
10	Jousting	Knights on horseback charge at each other with lances, aiming to unhorse their opponent.
11	Long Throw	Participants test their strength by throwing a heavy object as far as they can.
12	Mock Hunts	Simulated hunting games using archery or thrown weapons to hit moving targets.
13	Eating Contests	Competitions to see who can eat the most food in a set amount of time. Pies are a good example.
14	Puppetry and Theatrical Performances	Performances featuring puppets or actors that might include interactive elements with the audience.
15	Races & Chases	Competitions where participants take part in races and chases.
16	Ring Toss	Participants throw rings (typically made of rope or metal) onto a peg.
17	Sword Fighting	Contestants engage in one-to-one combat with blunted swords or wooden wasters.
18	Throwing Contest (Accuracy); Axes, Knives.	Participants throw projectiles at a wooden target, aiming for the bullseye.
19	Tug of War	Two teams pull on opposite ends of a rope, trying to drag the other team across a marker.
20	Wrestling	A contest of strength and technique where participants try to pin their opponents to the ground.

MARKET VENDORS

If you would like to have vendors for your festival or to design markets. Consider rolling on this chart 1d6+2 times.

d20	MARKET STALLS TABLE		
1	Baker's Cart: Selling an assortment of bread, pastries, and sweets baked fresh daily.	11	Mapmaker's Stand: Offering detailed maps, navigational charts, and compasses for travellers.
2	Book Peddler: Offering ancient tomes, spell scrolls, and maps of distant lands.	12	Musician's Corner: Showcasing musical instruments, sheet music, and recordings of enchanting melodies.
3	Candlemaker's Stand: Displaying an array of scented candles, lanterns, and magical light sources.	13	Potion Seller: Providing elixirs, tonics, and magical potions brewed by skilled alchemists.
4	Dye Merchant: Providing vibrant dyes, pigments, and fabrics for clothing and crafts.	14	Potter's Wheel: Displaying handmade pottery, mugs, bowls, and decorative ceramics.
5	Fletcher's Wagon: Selling bows, arrows, and quivers crafted from fine woods and enchanted materials.	15	Produce Stall: Displaying fresh fruits, vegetables, and herbs grown by local farmers.

6	Fortune Teller's Tent: Offering tarot readings, palmistry, and divination services to curious patrons.	16	Smithy's Forge: Selling weapons, armour, and metalwork crafted by skilled blacksmiths.
7	Fur Trader's Booth: Offering pelts, furs, and animal skins for warmth and decoration.	17	Tinker's Cart: Displaying an assortment of gadgets, trinkets, and magical oddities.
8	Herbalist's Stall: Offering potions, herbs, and remedies for various ailments.	18	Toy Merchant: Selling dolls, puzzles, and games for children and the young at heart.
9	Jeweller's Booth: Showcasing exquisite jewellery, gemstones, and enchanted amulets.	19	Textile Merchant: Selling fine fabrics, clothing, and tapestries woven with intricate designs.
10	Leatherworker's Tent: Offering leather armour, belts, pouches, and accessories crafted with precision.	20	Woodcarver's Stall: Showcasing intricately carved figurines, walking sticks, and wooden toys.

CARAVAN GENERATOR:

This generator will allow you to quickly create a merchant caravan which you can use in your towns. Roll 1d4 to determine caravan size. Then use the Table below to determine which trade good each merchant chooses. Finally, roll for the amount of merchants, guards, and travellers.

SMALL: 1d4-1 Travelling Merchants and 2d4 guards.

MEDIUM: 2d4+1 Travelling Merchants and 2d4 guards and 1d6 travellers.

LARGE: 2d4+2 Travelling Merchants and 3d6 guards and 4d6 travellers.

HUGE: 2d6+4 Travelling Merchants and 4d6 guards and 6d6 travellers.

D12	TRADE GOODS: LOW VALUE		TRADE GOODS: HIGH VALUE
1	COTTON / WOOL / FLAX	1	ARMOUR / WEAPONS
2	FURS / HIDES / SKINS	2	COFFEE / TEA
3	INGOTS	3	EXOTIC FRUITS
4	LUMBER	4	LEATHER / SILKS / FABRICS
5	WINE / ALE / BEER / LIQUEUR	5	GOLD / SILVER / PLATINUM
6	GRAIN / FOODSTUFFS	6	IVORY
7	LIVESTOCK / SLAVES	7	MEDICINE
8	SUGAR / SPICES / HEMP / JUTE / HERB / SALT	8	PERFUMES
9	DRESSED STONE	9	INGOTS
10	LEATHER	10	RELIGIOUS ARTEFACTS / BOOKS
11	PEWTER / BRONZE / COPPERWARE	11	POTIONS
12	WOODEN ITEMS	12	MAGICAL COMPONENTS

CREATURES & THEIR ACTIVITY

These two tables are designed to assist in creating dynamic events for your players to experience. While many resources offer similar tables, including them here ensures you have all the necessary tools in one place. Rather than using a formula to determine the size of the group, I have opted for a flexible approach. The disparity between a large group of goblins and a large group of dragons is significant, and it's best to tailor the group size to fit the specific context and needs of your campaign. Roll 2d4 and refer to the table below for the results.

d4	SIZE OF GROUP	d4	STATUS	DESCRIPTION
1	Small Group	1	Decimated	Brink of collapse, few allies. They are disorganised and desperately trying to survive.
2	Medium Group	2	Struggling	Resources are dwindling, frequently engaged in conflict and are at risk of being overpowered or displaced.
3	Large Group	3	Stable	Maintaining a steady hold. They have sufficient power and are able to handle most situations without major setbacks.
4	Full Faction	4	Dominant	Thriving. They have ample resources, territory, and allies. Presence is well-known and feared.

This chart is designed to help define the types of creatures you will use in your adventures and campaigns. Humanoids, being the most common in many fantasy stories, occupy almost half of the d20 range. The remaining numbers are allocated to other creature types. Note that this chart is tailored for a low-fantasy setting. If you are running a high-fantasy campaign, consider doubling each range: Humanoids would be 1-2, Beasts 3-4, and so on.

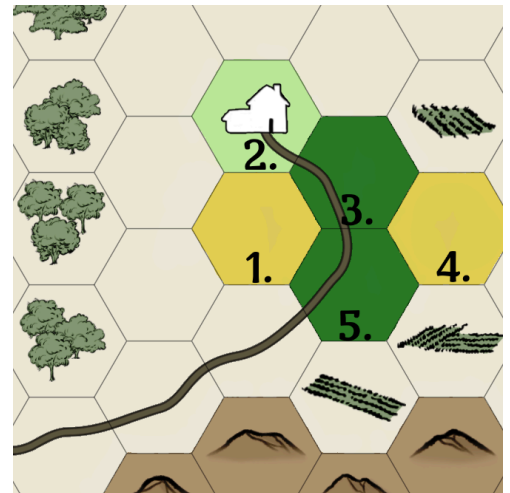
d20	TYPE	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLES
1-8	Humanoid	Creatures resembling humans in form and intelligence.	Humans, elves, dwarves, orcs, goblins
9-11	Beast	Non-magical animals found in nature.	Wolves, bears, spiders
12-13	Dire Beast	Enhanced animals.	Dire wolves, dire bears
14	Monstrosity	Creatures that defy easy categorization, often possessing bizarre or unnatural traits.	Chimaeras, manticores, griffins
15	Fey	Beings of magic and nature.	Sprites, dryads, satyrs and treants.
16	Elemental	Born from raw elemental forces of nature.	Elementals, djinn.
17	Undead	Reanimated corpses or spirits, fueled by dark magic or cursed energy.	Zombies, skeletons, ghosts, vampires
18	Fiend	Demons and Devils from the infernal realms	Imp, hellhound, incubus, cambion.
19	Aberrant	Bizarre and otherworldly creatures, often with strange anatomy and alien minds.	Beholders, mind flayers, aboleths.
20	Dragon	Winged reptilian creatures that are known to be both ancient and powerful.	Wymlings, drakes, wyvern, dragon.

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

With your hex map created and using the information you have on your settlement. You can begin to craft potential encounters that could occur whilst your players travel from one point to another. These can vary, but should be related to the district they are in. You can create encounter charts of varying size, but my recommendation would be d4, d6, d8, or 2d6 options. If you go with 2d6, have more frequent encounters be in the 5-9 range.

TOWN OF ASHBY - EXAMPLE SETTLEMENT

1. Commercial, Mercantile, Markets
2. Commercial, Infrastructure, Town Hall
3. Residential, Upper Class, Private Estates
4. Residential, Working Class, Popular Tavern
5. Commercial, Education, School



HOW TO USE RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

When using these charts. Have one player roll a d6 each time they move from one settlement hex to another. If they roll a 1, roll on your Random Encounter chart for the result.

Usually I create one chart for smaller settlements and maybe between 2 to 4 charts for large settlements. Take this smaller settlement above as an example. There are two Hexes which are Upper-Class (3 and 5) and two which are Lower-Class (1 and 4). I'd choose Random Encounters which can highlight their differences and potentially put them into conflict with each other. An example could be a thief steals a bag from a wealthy citizen, and is sprinting towards the Eastern Side of Town (Hex 4). Hex 2 represents the Town Hall, so perhaps that's where the Town Watch is located too.. Another encounter could be the party seeing an occasional patrol of watchmen, but they're mainly in Hex 2, 3, and 5. If you think this is complicated then you can choose to not do it, but I find that my players enjoy interacting with NPCs whilst they are in town. A random encounter chart can be easily used to create valuable moments and opportunities for roleplay which your players can use to learn more about the locations they are visiting.

These encounters are pretty broad and simple; and it's designed that way so you as a Dungeon Master can add to them on the fly. You could decide that the criminal from "Stop. Thief!" is a member of the Thieves' Guild. If the party takes them to the guards, they might be freed by corrupt officials or maybe the party will be confronted later down the line by other members who seek revenge. Keeping things simple allows you to get creative and create plots that you and your players will enjoy.

TOWN OF ASHBY - RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

1. **Stop. Thief!** A criminal has run away with someone's belongings, likely a bag or pouch.
2. **Stockades.** They spot a man in the stockade, likely a drunk or troublemaker.
3. **Collecting Donations** - A priest is collecting donations for the church. This might be for upkeep costs, repair damage, or for new improvements.
4. **On Patrol.** 1d4 Guardsmen pass the party.

LIST OF EXAMPLE ENCOUNTERS

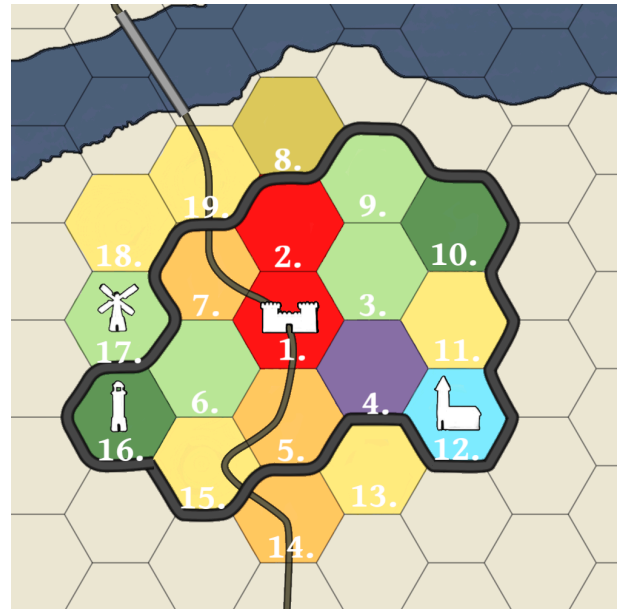
- **Stop. Thief!** A criminal has run away with someone's belongings, likely a bag or pouch.
- **On Patrol.** 1d4 Guardsmen pass the party.
- **Beggar.** A beggar approaches the party, asking for a coin or two.
- **Event.** A poster or flier of an upcoming event is spotted.
- **Taxi!** A wagon which allows for transportation around the settlement stops nearby and the passengers get out (Reroll if not a city).
- **Caravan Arrives.** A merchant caravan passes the party. There is a 2 in 6 chance they are of a different race to the settlement's owner.
- **Street Performers!** A group of 2d4 entertainers perform for people on the streets. They may be juggling, fire-breathing, playing music, or singing songs. Roll a d6 for how well received their performance is by watchers. 1 is awful, 6 is great.
- **Religious Guidance.** 1d4 Priests encourage people to attend prayer at the local place of worship.
- **Drunken Brawl.** Two men are fighting. Roll a d4 for each man to determine how well they are fighting. 1 is bad and 4 is good.
- **Building on Fire.** They smell smoke and come across a building ablaze. There is a 3 in 6 chance that 1d4 humanoids are trapped inside.
- **Public Execution.** People have gathered to watch someone be executed (hanging, guillotine, firing squad, bonfire).
- **Anti-Social Behaviour.** A random humanoid shouts something weird or obscene at the group, such as "STOP TOUCHING ME." when the group is clearly not touching them.
- **Construction Site.** They pass the construction site of a new home or business.
- **Stray Dogs.** They come across a pack of 1d4 stray dogs. Roll for their Reaction.
- **Thugs.** A group of thugs that outnumber your own group block the path asking for money.
- **Stockades.** They spot a man in the stockade, likely a drunk or troublemaker.
- **New Recruits.** A group of new guardsmen are being trained outside a military structure.
- **Prisoners.** A prison cart passes showing 1d4 criminals in a cage.
- **Bounties.** They spot a number of posters with wanted criminals or other bounties.
- **Buy my Things!** They pass street vendors, selling specific trade goods.
- **A Bustling Place.** Wagons filled with cargo pass the group.
- **Conversion** - 1d4 Priests are trying to persuade passersby to attend prayer at the church/temple.
- **Collecting Donations** - A priest is collecting donations for the church. This might be for upkeep costs, repair damage, or for new improvements.
- **Pilgrims Arrive** - A group of zealots who have recently arrived at town approach the party.
- **Religious Figure Arrives** - An influential member of the clergy passes the party, either on foot, horse, or carriage.
- **Public Ritual** - A group of priests perform a ritual, which could be baptism, consecration, perhaps even sacrificing a goat
- **Make Way!** - Noble/s pass by in carriage
- **Disguised Noble** - A disguised noble is on the streets; perhaps the party may recognise them.
- **Curious Guards** - The guards approach and ask "State your business."
- **Messenger** - A messenger carrying a sealed scroll passes the party.

EXAMPLE WRITE-UP - KEEP OF SUNSTONE

Ruled By: Baron Edmund "Brightshield"

Tall, Strong Build with broad shoulders and a commanding presence. His hair, once a fiery red, has now turned silver with age. He's a stoic and disciplined individual. He is firm but fair in his decisions, always striving to uphold justice and defend his lands.

1. **(Military)** The Keep of Sunstone (3 Levels, Rounded Keep). This is where the Commander, Gordon, can be found.
2. **(Military)** Barracks/Prison - Includes a Stables with War Horses. This is where the Sergeant, Lydia, can be found.
3. **(Commercial)** Mercantile - Town Hall. Town administrators work from the Town Hall, where they create new bills.
4. **(Nobility)** Palace - Home of the Baron, his family, and many servants.
5. **(Residential)** Working Class - Tavern - "The Leering Weasel", also home to a well known Blacksmith called Russel.
 - **The Leering Weasel:**
 - 1 Story, timber & brick, "worn in".
 - Cots in Main Room (Common Quality)
 - Has a collection of obscure animal skeletons
 - Tavern is known for food, served in small portions.
 - Signature dish is Veal pie with herbs, dates and eggs.
 - **Russel's Blacksmith (5):**
 - Does weapons
 - **Noris' Blacksmith (5):**
 - Does tools
 - Gravelly, gruff voice
 - Looks like a confederate general (handlebar moustache)
6. **(Commercial)** Mercantile - Merchant's Guild. The Guildhouse also doubles up as a Tradehouse, where merchants, travellers and adventurers alike can barter and trade goods.
 - **Bert's Trinkets and Oddities**
 - **Owner:** Bert Goodfellow, a jovial halfling with a rotund belly and a twinkle in his eye. He wears a colourful patchwork coat and a floppy hat adorned with feathers.
 - **Personality:** Bert is a friendly and outgoing fellow, always eager to strike up a conversation with anyone who passes by his stall. He has a knack for storytelling and loves to regale his customers with tales of his travels and adventures.
 - **Merchandise:** Bert's stall is filled with an eclectic mix of trinkets, baubles, and oddities from all corners of the realm. From polished stones and interesting shells to small figurines and mysterious artefacts,



there's something for everyone. Prices range from 1 to 10 gold pieces, depending on the rarity and uniqueness of the item.

- A man wearing a dark robe was spotted here preaching about austerity within the city.
- 7. **(Residential)** Working Class - Tavern "The Green Halberd"
 - **The Green Halberd:**
 - 2 story, timber & brick, new.
 - Run by Old Bill, ex-soldier. He has a trophy wife (who is rumoured to be the daughter of local hardman, Tony Two-Fingers)
 - Medium rooms /w straw mattresses (Common Quality)
 - Comes with a small bath house.
 - Exterior has well-groomed hedges.
 - Tavern is known for the quality of its food.
 - Signature dish is Chicken in thick wine sauce
- 8. **(Residential)** Working Class - Pit Fighting. This is unknown to player characters unless they investigate the area, speaking to locals about the best place to fight. The town administration wants to shut down the pit fighting so that the sports arena will get more focus.
- 9. **(Commercial)** Theater - Sports Arena. Various contents from jousting, sword-on-sword, and crucibles take place here.
- 10. **(Residential)** Wealthy - Fountain. Many of the wealthier people in the town live here around a beautiful fountain depicting Lathander the Morninglord.
- 11. **(Commercial)** Gate - Warehouses. One of the main exits is located here along with a Guard House.
- 12. **(Religious)** Temple - Cathedral. The Great Temple of Helm the Watcher is located here in the town. It is one of the oldest buildings in the Town and is home to powerful relics that have been lost to time.
- 13. **(Commercial)** Poor - Tenement. A large tenement is home to more than two hundred people here, mostly dwarves and migrating humans.
- 14. **(Residential)** Working Class - Taverns
- 15. **(Commercial)** Gate - Warehouses. The lower gate is located here and hosts two watch posts. Soldiers patrol the walls of the town, ready to defend against attack.
- 16. **(Residential)** Wealthy - Home of the Order of Wizards within the Town.
 - **Alfred the Red (Archivist)** Quick-witted, speaks fast, always looking for a deal, Humankind - 2 - 3, PU/FA, Physical Universe / Fauna, 4/6/7/8, History & Genealogy, Legends, Lore and Myth, Law & Customs, Philosophy and Ethics.
- 17. **(Recreational)** Orchard (Wine)
- 18. **(Commercial)** Meatpacking - Slaughterhouse
- 19. **(Commercial)** Gate - Warehouses. The town's wheelwright is located here, where wheels, carts, and wagons are produced. Lots of lumber is brought through the town to this location, close to the river's edge.

These are examples of Hex Maps made with Wonderdraft for the Barrowmaze Module.

